Task 3b

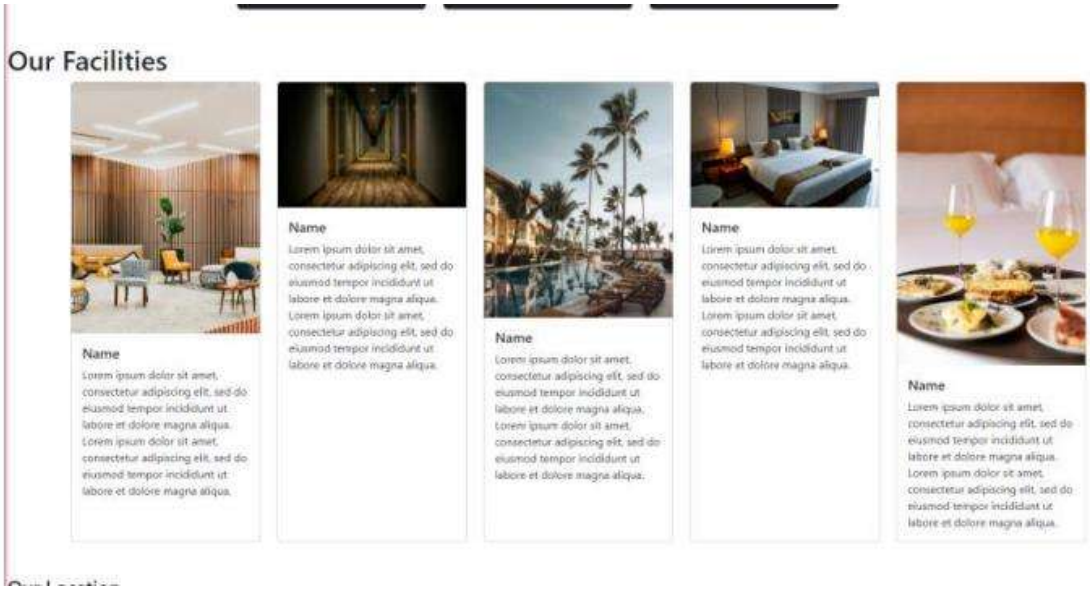
Introduction

In this passage, I will be evaluating the effectiveness of the digital solution that I've been developing during this assessment period and how it meets requirements. As well as that I will be sharing my ideas as to how the solution can be developed further.

The effectiveness of the assets and content used:

The reasoning behind selection

Most of the assets on the website were chosen in the design stage and then implemented during development. I have carefully chosen all of them, to make sure they are a good representation of my client – RZA adventures.



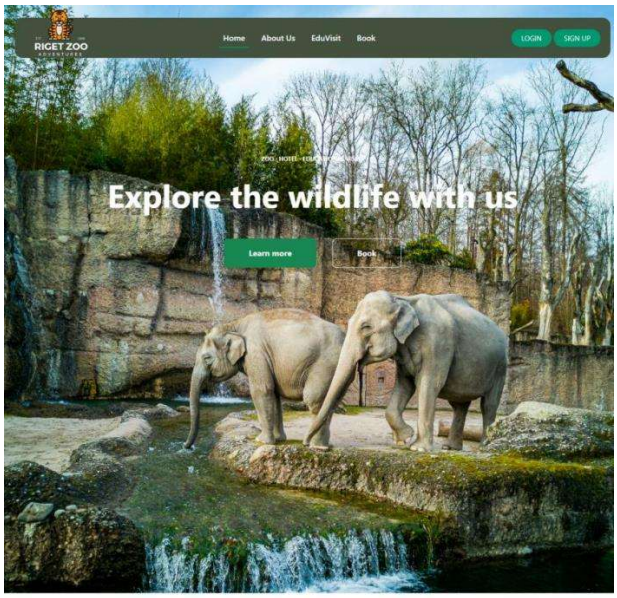
Some of the assets like hotel pictures for our facilities section shown above, were chosen slightly later in the process, as I have decided to add this section after the beginning of the development.

Home page background:

I have chosen this specific background for various reasons such as:

- It is a good representation of the zoo, and user can very quickly understand what this website is for, when gathering feedback, I have established that the average user can understand the purpose of the website very quickly. Therefore, it seems now like this picture suites just right.
- It helps to emphasize that RZA is wild safari zoo
- It has a good contrast, thus suitable for different types of end users
- It fits the colour palate that I have previously chosen perfectly

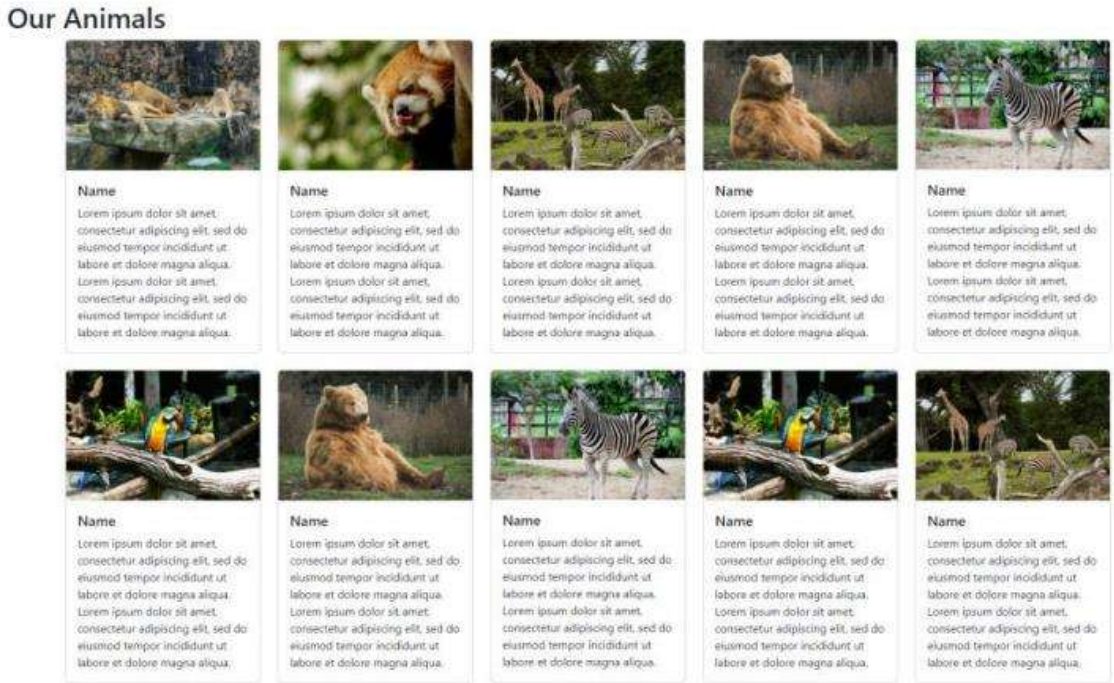
Even though this background seems to me a good solution, it is worth mentioning that is can be easily changed when needed. For example, maybe my client will decide on a different background for different seasons, all that needs to be done is replacing image in the assets folder.



About page

On the about page I have added four sections: animals, opening times, facilities and location.

All those sections have some assets included. For example, Animals section has handful of animal pictures in there. I have chosen these assets in order to capture the eye of the protentional customers, as well as that it will give the end user a chance to see what they are up for if they decide to visit RZA.



In opening times section, I have carefully chosen the background to emphasize on the amazing experience end users can get if they decide to visit rza.

For our facilities I have chosen different types of pictures to show the overall experience they will get in rza hotel.

In location section I have embedded Google map API. I have decided to do so to make the website more interactive and to enhance user experience.

For the booking pages I have chosen relevant background, for example if you are booking a ticket the background will show the zoo, but if you are booking a room the background will be a hotel lobby, which will make user experience more intuitive and smoother. It will also prevent user form mistakenly booking a wrong ticket.

For User page I have chosen a nice animals flamingos background, however I covered it with black opacity 0.5 shade in order to make sur that it is not distracting user.

The validity and reliability

For all the assets I have used a reliable source such as unsplash, for API I have used Google API. Because I have not added any content like RZA history, information about animals or facilities, there is no risk of invalid information, once the content is provided by the client, then it is going to be added to the website. Specifically, to prevent erroneous information and content on the website I have used Lorem ipsum text as a placeholder in all the places that require some info.

Legal and ethical implications

All the background pictures and icons are Copy right free, therefore legal to use and there is no need to change them before the deployment, unless the client has its own pictures that would like to be used instead. As for the content once again, I think it would be completely unethical to just copy it from competitors' website or just have it written by the AI and therefore I have used placeholders instead.

How the digital solution meets the requirements of the solution

Functional and non-functional requirements

Functional requirements

In my proposal I have stated that the system should include:

- Home page
- About page
- Educational visit page
- Booking System
- Login/Signup/Account system

The solution that I have produced meets all those requirements. I have developed the website that I very close to the initial designs and proposal.

It has the homepage, about page with all 4 required sections: Opening times, Our animals, Hotel info, how to get here. EduVisit page that has main section where the user can browse the catalogue of useful materials (now they are just placeholders, however when content is provided by the client it will contain all that is required). Booking System that has a main page where user can choose what to book: a room or a ticket. Then user is directed to that page. I have changed the logic of the system from the initial design. In the initial proposal I have proposed to make a system that would ask user for details like email and name every time that the booking is made. However, while developing the solution, I realised that this is not the best way to go about it. Instead, the system now checks if the user is signed in, if not kindly asks to sign in or create account first and then to make a booking. In the way, the database is well structured and is easy to track KPI's for my client, however it is also useful for users as it is much quicker and prevents from entering wrong details.

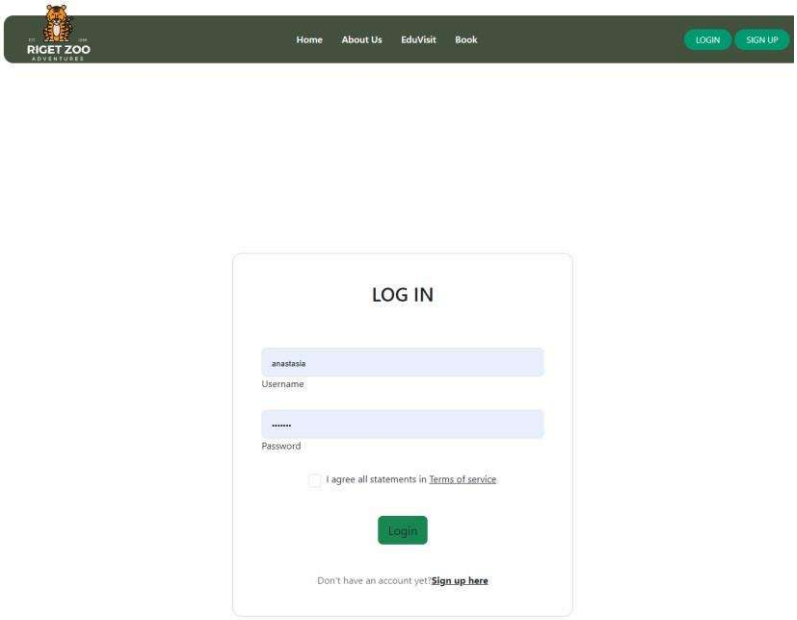
Login system has been developed exactly like I proposed, and I have used same required inputs that I previously proposed, please see belove.

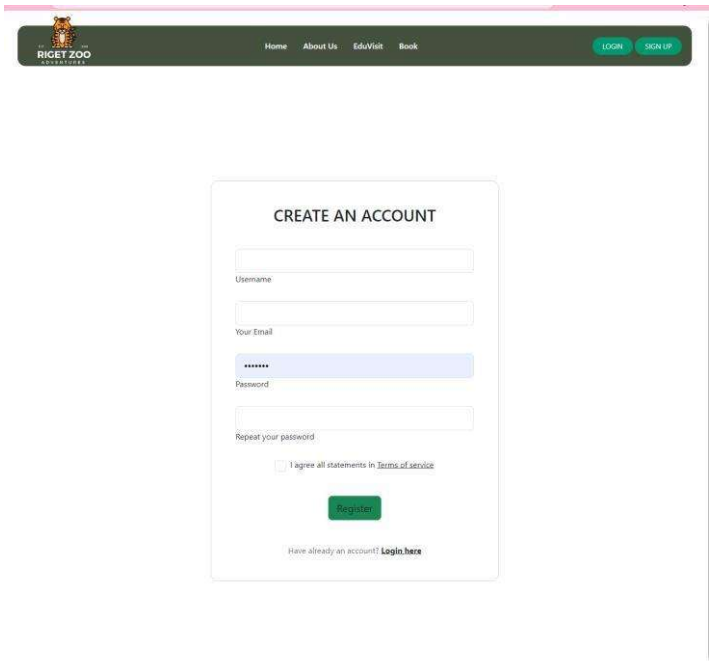
Personal Account

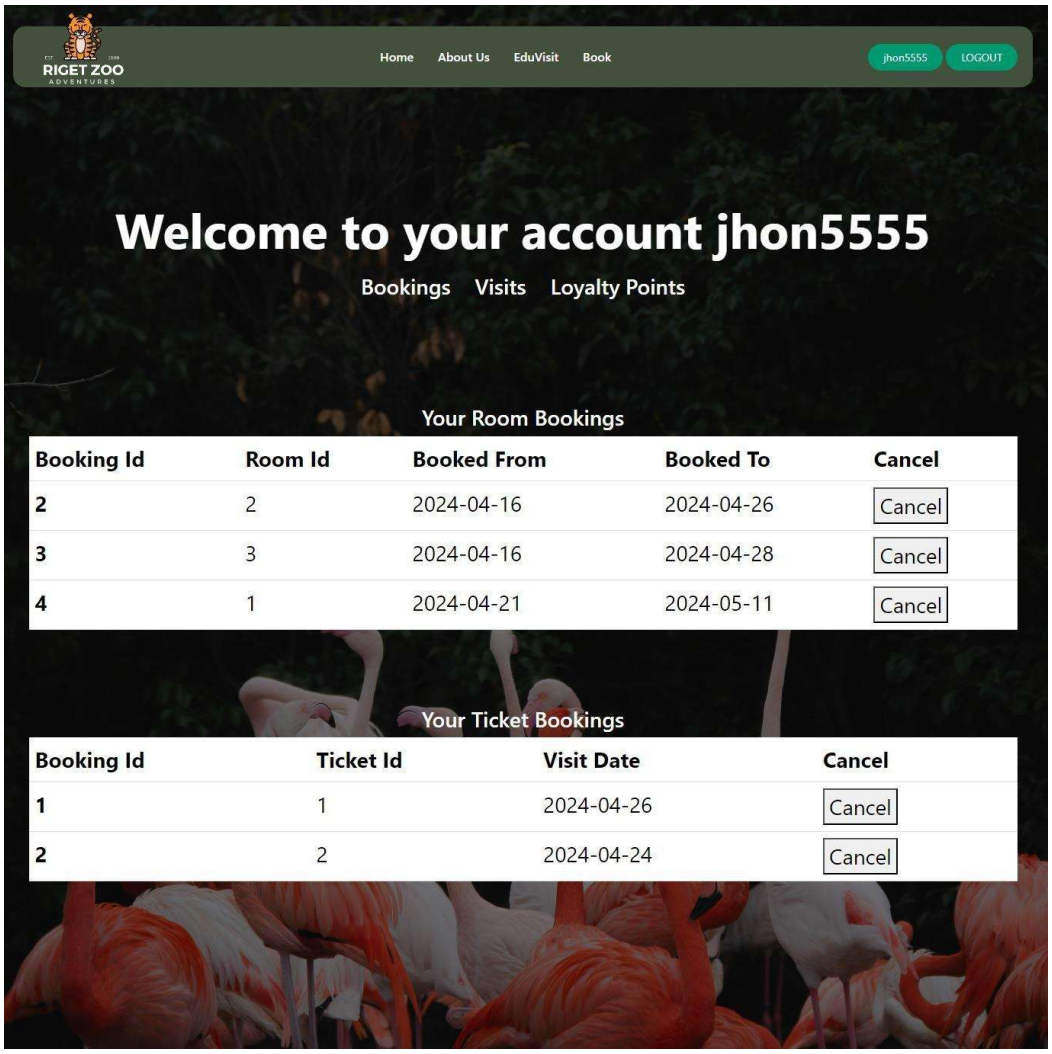
The system should allow user to create an account, or sign in, if the account already exists. Once signed in to their account user should be able to manage their bookings ex. cancel, user should also see previous stays and rewards. The system should allow user to log out once needed.

User input requirements to create an account:

User input requirements to login into the account:


RIGET ZOO
Home
About Us
EduVisit
Book
LOGIN
SIGN UP
LOG IN
anastasia
Username
Password
I agree all statements in Terms of service
Login
Don't have an account yet?Sign up here


RIGET ZOO
Home
About Us
EduVisit
Book
LOGIN
SIGN UP
CREATE AN ACCOUNT
Username
Your Email
Password
Repeat your password
I agree all statements in Terms of service
Register
Have already an account? Login here



Non-functional requirements

Security considerations

The system should be secure and robust:

- System must validate all data inputs.
- System must use secure cookies.
- System must use SHA256 Encryption for the passwords.

All the inputs are validated on the backend level, I have essentially considered both types of validation: frontend(html) validation and backend validation. I have chosen to go with backend validation as it is the most secure method. It prevents malicious users from submitting wrong data using developer tools in browser, whereas html does not protect from this.

System uses secure cookies.

The solution contains signup/login system, I made sure it is secure by hashing all the passwords using SHA256 Encryption before they reach the database and then they're stored in that way.

Accessibility features

- The system should be straightforward to use, both for the end-users and the content editors that oversee backend system.
- System should be adapted to different user needs: the system should be following Web Content
- Accessibility (WCAG) guidelines

All of those requirements are met in the solution. Before starting to develop the prototype, I have made sure that my previous design is inclusive for different types of users. For example, I have checked if all the colours and contrasts are accepted by the WCAG by using online checker.

Another example would be a map API that is easier to use then just a small text in the footer stating the location.

As well as that, I made sure that the website is easy and intuitive to navigate. I have added "walk through" and validation messages all throughout the website. For example, once user clicked on register and wants to switch to sign in, there are two ways to do so, first is to click on the "Already a member? Login" or just to click on the sign up in the navigation bar.

KPI's

For the moment it is just a prototype, and it has no users to track KPI's. For example, KPI's like bounce rate or average time on the page are not yet sensible as it has not been deployed and runs on the localhost. However, it has a working login system and booking system, and all that data is stored on the database in the different tables. By analysing this data business can have insights on how many new users there are, what is the percentage of the users that booked a ticket online or booked a room or both. For example, it would be useful to know the tendency in relations between booking the ticket and the room to understand what rza get more revenue from. As well as that, RZA could track how many bookings were made per month as I have included automatic timestamps for all the records, and then analyse positive and negative trends. Because I have added those timestamps for when each account is created RZA can also track how many inactive accounts there are and potentially delete them after a year or so.

How the prototype could be developed further

First of all, in farther development there should be all the required content added, as for this solution I have not provided the content like animals' info, hotel info. Before deploying this info should be added.

Secondly, because of the security considerations I have not added the feature to buy a ticket or pay for the room in advance. However, I this it would be a sensible feature to have as some users may want to do just that.

Thirdly, it was my intention to develop a rewards system, for example when the user, has three visits to the zoo in her/his account, they get a free visit next or discount on the room, which is a good stimulation for customers. However, in this scope I was not able to develop it. Once the user page is displayed after logging in, there is a placeholder for "Loyalty points" though. Therefore, once it is developed it will be very beneficial feature for the RZA to have.

Another feature, that I consider to be a great feature is Animal API, that could be added to the education page. For example, user is interested in a particular animal, he/she enters the name of the animal and some interesting facts about the animal will be displayed.

Finally, the hosting of the website, currently it is running on the localhost. But to be a live projected it should be deployed.